



Photo: NRC/ Fredrik Lemeryd

Nostexo (6) waits at the Dadaab airstrip to board a plane to Mogadishu, Somalia. She was one of about 23,000 refugees who left Dadaab refugee camp in 2016 to return back to Somalia.

KENYA

Need for voluntary, safe and dignified repatriation of refugees

Kenya sits between two regional displacement crises: South Sudan and Somalia. In 2016 Kenya hosted some 460,000 refugees in Dadaab and Kakuma camps, and in urban settings mainly in Nairobi. The overwhelming majority of the refugees were from Somalia (334,000). Some have been here since the 1990's. Ongoing fighting in South Sudan led to a continuous stream of South Sudanese refugees (91,000) fleeing to Kakuma camp.

The Tripartite Agreement between the governments of Somalia and Kenya, and UNHCR on the closure of the Dadaab camp was due to expire in November 2016. Following intensive advocacy, including by NRC, the Kenyan government extended the closure of Dadaab camp by six months. Our advocacy included publishing a position paper titled 'Dadaab's broken promise – A call to reinstate voluntary, safe and dignified returns for the Dadaab refugee community'.

Food security and livelihoods

NRC's food security and livelihoods programme worked to protect and stabilise affected families, by ensuring access to emergency food during times of crisis.

We provided direct food and non-food asset distributions. In settings where markets functioned, we responded to livelihood security through cash transfers, livelihood diversification, access to labour, credit support and agricultural support.

We also supported livelihood recovery in Dadaab and Mandera, through activities that addressed recovery and long-term needs through cash transfers, material grants, diversification from traditional livelihoods and skills enhancement in small business management. We reached some 199,000 people in 2016 with food security and livelihoods interventions.

Water, sanitation and hygiene

The benefits from improved access to safe and sufficient water supplies contributed to saving lives and protecting livelihoods of people affected by displacement. Access to sanitation facilities reduced water-borne diseases and provided a clean living environment free from open defecation, liquid and solid wastes. More than 300,000 people received various types of water, sanitation and hygiene support in 2016.

Education

The Kenya programme supported displacement-affected and vulnerable children and youth to access basic education and skills development opportunities.

The programme provided out-of-school youths with the Accelerated Learning Programme (ALP), which is a flexible, age appropriate programme that promotes access to education in an accelerated period. It provided students with equivalent certified competencies for basic education and learning approaches that matched their abilities.



Adult literacy class in Kakuma refugee camp. The adult literacy programme gives adults the opportunity to learn reading, writing and numeracy skills.

Through the Youth Education Pack Programme (YEP), young people gained market-oriented vocational skills training, basic literacy, numeracy and life skills. The trainees received business start-up support once the training was completed.

NRC worked closely with the government and technical vocational education training institutes to ensure adherence to the curriculum, capacity building, quality monitoring, assessments and certification.

We used technology in education mainstreaming in the programme through instant network schools. This was an initiative implemented with UNHCR, Vodafone and the Safaricom foundation. Students used computer tablets, loaded with online and offline content for teaching and personal learning. In our education centres, basic computer literacy was offered to all students.

Information, counselling and legal assistance (ICLA)

NRC supported Somali refugees in Dadaab and Kakuma camps with information about living conditions in their home countries. We also told them about the voluntary repatriation process so they could make informed decisions about returning to their home countries. NRC's information, counselling and legal assistance programme in Kenya raised awareness among displaced people about their legal rights, obligations and entitlements. It did this by providing information services on issues such as legal identity and housing, land and property rights.

NRC also expanded its casework and partnership approach in 2016 with local legal aid providers providing counselling and legal assistance for refugees in Dadaab camps, Nairobi and Mandera. We also supported capacity building among displacement-affected communities, local authorities and humanitarian partners on housing, land and property rights, and collaborative dispute resolution.

Shelter

Shelter was required for new arrivals to the refugee camps, including the new site of Kalobeyei in Kakuma. Even with the construction of transitional shelters, a 42 per cent gap remained by the end of the year, of those who needed durable, locally adapted and cost-effective shelter solutions.

Refugees in Kenya had limited access to livelihood options in 2016. This was due to resistance from host communities and limits imposed by national authorities on harvesting local materials for construction.

To address shelter gaps, NRC supported activities aimed at improving access to quality and culturally acceptable shelters, to foster dignity, protection and enhance livelihoods through host community and refugee owned cooperatives. The projects integrated refugees in shelter construction through tailored training on construction procedures and practices.

THE DEADLIEST JOB



Photo: NRC/Fredrik Lemeryd

In a small shipping container, Mano administers radio programmes for refugees in Dadaab.

At least 59 journalists were killed in Somalia between 1992 and 2016. Mano (27) was one of the lucky ones who escaped with her life. But becoming a refugee didn't stop her determination to report.

Mano sits in front of a microphone inside a small container that functions as a refugee radio station in Dadaab. She is focused on practicing lines for the midday show that is about to start.

"I'm a Somali journalist," she says proudly. Mano is also a refugee. One of about 290,000 people living in Kenya's Dadaab refugee camp, one of the largest camp in the world.

Mano signed up at NRC's journalist training school in Dadaab, where she is studying as a field reporter and radio presenter.

"I like reporting on issues that affect women. Radio Gargar is the only station in the camp covering humanitarian issues," she says. But covering women's issues isn't something Mano was able to do back in Mogadishu.

"One day I was reporting on a government bombardment in a town that killed some Al Shabaab fighters. That evening Shabaab called me and offered me money to stop reporting. I told them I'm a journalist and work for the people. The next day I reported the news again. That night they came to my home. I escaped to my aunt's. The following day I fled to Kenya with my three children."

That was four years ago. Now Mano lives with her five children in Dadaab refugee camp. The youngest two were born in the camp and have never been to Somalia.

"One day I would like to return to Somalia," says Mano. "But for now it's not safe for journalists, so I cannot go home," she says.

Radio Gargar set up its offices in 2013 as part of NRC's youth education programme, and is funded by the US government and UNHCR. It is a one-year informal education programme designed to support young people like Mano, who have a lack of opportunity or missed school. Through the programme, youths acquire skills like journalism to improve their chances of finding a job.